

Prepare your laptop for the AI agent workshop

Women in Tech Insight, Kraków

Please finish these steps **at least 48 hours before the workshop**. Allow around 30-45 minutes, plus download time. We will use our two hours together for learning and building a recruitment coach with fictional data.

You will work on **your own laptop**. No previous AI experience is required. The notebook provides short Python cells, explanations and guided edits; you will not type a whole program from scratch.

What to bring

Your Windows, macOS or Linux laptop, charger and permission to install software. A tablet or phone is not sufficient. For a managed university or work laptop, arrange IT support before the event.

What to install

Software	Where to get it
Standard Python 3.12-3.14	python.org downloads Use a normal stable build, not a preview.
Visual Studio Code desktop	Download VS Code This is separate from Python.
Microsoft extensions in VS Code	Open Extensions. Install Python (ms-python.python) and Jupyter (ms-toolsai.jupyter). Check the publisher is Microsoft.

Windows: finish the Python installer or install manager steps, then restart VS Code. **macOS:** after the python.org installer, run **Install Certificates.command** from its Python folder in Applications. **Linux:** use a supported Python version with pip and venv; package names depend on your distribution.

You do not need: Docker, a cloud subscription, a paid AI coding assistant, Google Colab or a separate JupyterLab installation. Do not enter payment details for this workshop.

Open the folder and create an environment

Download the complete **02_PARTICIPANTS** folder from the organizer. If downloaded as a ZIP, **extract it first**. Keep all files together. Do not open a notebook inside a ZIP or a Google Drive preview.

File	What it is for
00_Preflight_EN.ipynb	Check preparation before the event.
01_Recruitment_Coach_EN.ipynb	Your main workshop notebook.
workshop_support.py	Prepared Python helpers used by the notebook.
requirements.txt	The exact Python packages to install.

In VS Code, choose **File > Open Folder** and select the extracted folder. Check that these files appear in the Explorer on the left. If asked about trust, verify the organizer as the source before trusting the folder.

Create the workshop environment

An environment keeps this workshop's Python packages in a separate **.venv** folder.

1. Open the Command Palette: **Ctrl+Shift+P** on Windows/Linux or **Cmd+Shift+P** on macOS.
2. Run **Python: Create Environment** and choose **Venv**.
3. Select your standard Python 3.12-3.14 installation.
4. Keep the name **.venv** if asked.
5. Select **requirements.txt** when offered and wait for installation to finish.

Already have this workshop's .venv? Use it instead. The requirements currently pin google-genai==2.23.0 and ipykernel==7.3.0.

Only if the packages were not installed

Choose **Terminal > New Terminal**. It must open in the extracted workshop folder. Run the command for your system.

Windows PowerShell

```
.\.venv\Scripts\python.exe -m pip install -r requirements.txt
```

macOS or Linux

```
./venv/bin/python -m pip install -r requirements.txt
```

These commands do not require the py launcher or environment activation. If .venv does not exist, finish the creation steps first.

Select your kernel and prepare private access

Select the notebook kernel

A **kernel** is the Python process that runs notebook cells. Select it even if VS Code already shows a Python version in its status bar.

1. Open **00_Preflight_EN.ipynb** from the Explorer.
2. Click **Select Kernel** at the top right.
3. If needed, choose **Select Another Kernel**, then **Python Environments**.
4. Select this workshop folder's **.venv**.

A notebook alternates reading cells with code cells. Use the triangle beside one code cell to run it, then wait for completion. During this workshop, follow the numbered cells in order rather than using Run All.

Confirm the online route with the organizer

Only prepare and use online access after the organizer confirms the approved account and project arrangement. If that confirmation has not arrived, complete the local setup and report that Gemini access is awaiting approval. Do not enable billing yourself.

Gemini API and AI Studio require users to be 18 or older and in a supported region. Google may ask for age verification. Use an approved account that you can sign into on your own laptop.

Use an AI Studio authorization key

After approval, open [Google AI Studio](#) and use its API key page to create or select your own **authorization key**, also called an **auth key**, in the approved project. New AI Studio keys are auth keys. An older standard key may no longer work; follow the current [Google key guide](#).

Keep the key private. Paste it **only into the notebook's hidden input prompt** when the connection cell asks for it. Never put it into a code cell, email, chat, screenshot or shared document. Helpers do not need your key.

Do not add a payment method, upgrade, share keys, or create extra projects to bypass a limit. If account access is blocked, contact the organizer and keep working locally.

What the workshop sends

Live cells send your exercise instructions and supplied fictional tool results to Gemini. Use only the fictional workshop data. Do not add real CVs, applicant records, employer documents or confidential information.

Run the four preflight cells

Open **00_Preflight_EN.ipynb** and run from top to bottom. A successful local check and a successful Gemini check are two different results.

1 Check Python and packages

Leave **CONNECT = False** and **RUN_LIVE = False**. Run the local setup cell. Look for **PYTHON CHECK PASSED** and confirm the Python path belongs to this workshop's **.venv**. This step does not contact Gemini.

If it says **INCOMPLETE**, **MISSING**, or reports the wrong package version, finish installation or select the correct kernel before continuing.

2 Connect with a private key

After organizer approval, change **CONNECT = False** to **CONNECT = True** in the connection cell and run it. Paste your auth key into the hidden input box, then press Enter.

CLIENT READY means the client was created. It does not yet prove a model request works. If the cell appears to wait, check for an input box near the top of VS Code.

3 Make one real request

In the separate request cell, change **RUN_LIVE = False** to **RUN_LIVE = True**. Run it and type **RUN** when asked. This sends one API request. Look for **GEMINI CHECK PASSED**.

INCOMPLETE or **NOT RUN** is not a successful API check. Stop after one successful request. This verifies basic connectivity; the organizer will separately rehearse the complete agent and its tools.

4 Report readiness and close

Run the Finish cell to close the client. Then **edit the earlier source cells** back to **CONNECT = False** and **RUN_LIVE = False**. Save the notebook. A later cell that resets a variable does not rewrite the earlier cell text.

Send this status to the organizer

```
System: Windows / macOS / Linux
Local: PASSED / INCOMPLETE / error
Gemini: PASSED / INCOMPLETE / NOT RUN
If blocked: short error message with secrets removed
```

Send this at least 48 hours before the workshop. Never include your key. If online access is awaiting approval, say so in the last line.

Troubleshooting and checklist

What you see	Your next step
No Python or .venv available	Finish Python installation, restart VS Code and repeat page 2.
py is not recognized	Use the VS Code environment steps. The commands on page 2 use .venv directly.
ModuleNotFoundError	Select the correct .venv kernel, then install requirements. If workshop_support is missing, open the whole extracted folder.
Restricted Mode	Verify the source of the folder and enable trust only for the organizer-supplied files.
Authentication or permission error	Check the approved project and auth key in AI Studio. Report the error without the key.
429 or a quota message	Stop rerunning. Tell the organizer and use local exercises; do not rotate keys or projects.

Your final checklist

- ☐ Laptop and charger packed.
- ☐ ZIP extracted and all files kept together.
- ☐ Correct .venv selected in 00_Preflight_EN.ipynb.
- ☐ Local status and separate Gemini status sent to the organizer.
- ☐ Live switches restored to False and no key in source or screenshots.

During class, open **01_Recruitment_Coach_EN.ipynb**. All code is already supplied in short cells. The **WORKSHOP_HANDBOOK_EN.html** file contains copyable code, the worksheet, examples, theory and sources. Download it and open it in a browser.

If Gemini is unavailable, continue the local tools and use the clearly labelled C24 simulation. It does not call a model or test a changed skill recipe. If Python itself cannot run, the handbook supports reading and prediction while a helper assists; that is not a completed code run.

Official help

[VS Code environments](#) [Notebook kernels](#) [Python on macOS](#)
[Google account access](#) [API keys](#) [Quotas](#) [Gemini API terms](#)

Package instructions revised 18 September 2026; technical guidance checked 17 September. Menus, access rules and quotas can change. Follow any event-specific update from the organizer.